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"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, partly sunny, light winds, high 61. **Tonight,** clear, light winds, low 45. **Tomorrow,** plenty of sunshine, light and variable winds, high 64. Weather map is on Page B12.

VOL. CLXXVI .... No. 61,047 © 2026 The New York Times Company SATURDAY, OCTOBER 24, 2026 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00

New Vaccine Offering Hope On Melanoma

Momentum Is Building for Cancer Therapies

By NINA AGRAWAL

An experimental vaccine developed by Merck and Moderna could become the first vaccine of its kind used to treat cancer. Scientists hope it won't be the last.

On Thursday, the drug makers announced that patients with melanoma who received a vaccine tailored to help their immune systems attack their tumors were 42 percent less likely to experience a recurrence of the cancer within two years than those who did not receive the vaccine. The companies have yet to show the treatment can prolong melanoma patients' overall survival.

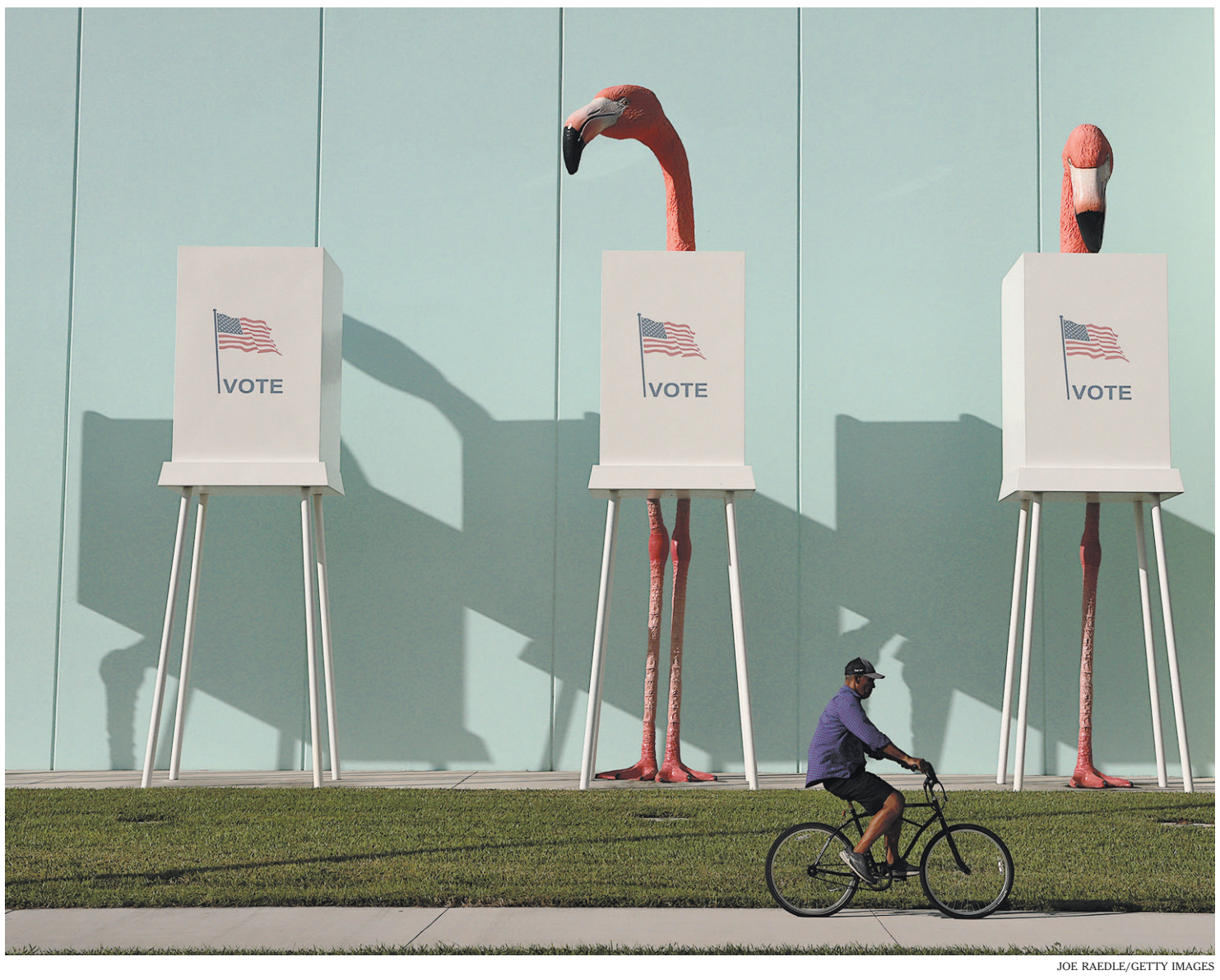
The results come at a time of great momentum in the development of cancer vaccines — an idea scientists have tried and failed to realize for decades.

"There have been thousands of papers written on therapeutic cancer vaccines," said Dr. Steven Rosenberg, chief of the surgery branch at the National Cancer Institute and a pioneer of immunotherapy, the use of the body's immune system to fight cancer.

Buoyed by recent scientific advances, however, researchers are now testing whether such vaccines could one day be used for a range of cancers, including hard-to-treat ones like pancreatic and brain cancer. Those efforts have been bolstered by investments from drug makers like Moderna as well as hospitals like Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center, which in 2024 established a center dedicated to designing, producing and administering cancer vaccines on site. This year, the federal government also announced a $200 million public-private partnership to advance these vaccines.

There is still reason for skepticism. It's unclear, for example, whether other cancers will re-

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JOE RAEDLE/GETTY IMAGES

Big Names Flock to Florida
Art with a message in West Palm Beach. Surrogates of all feathers are trying to sway votes in a state seemingly less red. Page A13.

Challenger Casts Himself as the Anti-Netanyahu

Eisenkot Has Lead, but His Low-Key Style Is Worrying Backers

This article is by ***David M. Halbfinger****,* ***Natan Odenheimer*** *and* ***Johnatan Reiss****.*

HAIFA, Israel — Gadi Eisenkot doesn't speak like a politician. He runs through his plans matter-of-factly, like a commander spelling out a mission to his troops.

It's an unusual style of campaigning, and scarcely electrifying; he doesn't so much appeal to voters as state what he sees as the obvious.

But for Mr. Eisenkot, a former Israeli military chief and the leading candidate against Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in Tuesday's election, it reflects who he is, how he approaches leadership and how serious he believes Israel's problems have become.

It also reflects the grief he felt as father to a son killed two months into Israel's war in Gaza — grief that was on vivid display when he delivered a eulogy on national television.

Mr. Eisenkot, 66, says he is running to "save Israel." In his view, Mr. Netanyahu has embroiled Israel in forever wars, destroyed its international standing and decimated its support in the United

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WEST BANK ATTACK After a fatal shooting, Benjamin Netanyahu vowed a major offensive. PAGE A7



AMIT ELKAYAM FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Gadi Eisenkot, in Haifa last month, is the top candidate against Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in Tuesday's election. He called Mr. Netanyahu an "anti-leader" who avoids accountability.

For Talarico, Texas Record Tells 2 Stories

By LAUREN MCGAUGHY

AUSTIN, Texas — James Talarico's record in the Texas Legislature has been a tale of two Talaricos.

There's the Talarico who flipped a competitive state house district around Austin and arrived in the Capitol in 2019 as a 29-year-old, a Democrat preaching bipartisan cooperation. There, he accomplished things by working with Republicans, including 39 bills that became law with his name on them.

Then there's the Talarico who was a vocal progressive fighter, especially after Republicans redrew his district lines, pushing him to run in a liberal Austin area. Voters there cheered as he fought unsuccessfully against religion in public schools and in favor of transgender rights.

The first Talarico earned accolades even from some of his Republican colleagues in the Legislature they dominate. The second, which helped catapult him into the national spotlight, is being used against him in his U.S. Senate run.

Mr. Talarico has tried to balance his two political identities throughout his four terms in the Texas House, according to a New York Times review of his record and interviews with more than a dozen current and former legislators. Even as he worked against partisan bills pushed by the Legislature's conservative majority, the

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TRUMP'S THREAT COULD THWART VOTE IN ALASKA

CITING SIMILAR NAMES

Seeks Block of Results in Event G.O.P. Senator Loses Narrowly

By DEVLIN BARRETT and KELLEN BROWNING

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration has asked a federal court to block certification of the Senate election in Alaska if the Republican incumbent narrowly loses, a highly unusual move that signaled an effort to potentially intervene in the outcome.

President Trump made clear on Friday that he had demanded the lawsuit, acknowledging how directly he has harnessed the Justice Department to carry out his wishes. "I'm the one that said do it," he told reporters.

The Justice Department, in the lawsuit filed in federal court in Alaska on Thursday, argued that confusion over a candidate on the ballot with a name very similar to that of the incumbent, Senator Dan S. Sullivan, could taint the election result.

Polls show that the senator is in a close race against Mary Peltola, a Democrat. However, the four-person ballot also includes Daniel J. Sullivan Jr., and does not list any party registration. The senator's line on the state ballot describes him as the incumbent.

The administration's new legal gambit highlights its intensifying efforts to claim authority over the midterm elections, as control of Congress hangs in the balance. Elections are administered by state and local officials, but in recent weeks, the Trump administration has filed lawsuits seeking to alter how states like Alaska and California do so.

David Becker of the Center for Election Innovation & Research, a nonpartisan group that advises election officials, said he could not recall a similar instance in which the federal government had sought to block certification of an election, "and certainly not 11 days before an election." State officials have already addressed the issue of the candidate with a similar name, he said.

"D.O.J. making this claim this late smells of political interference and is against D.O.J. policy," Mr. Becker said. "The feds have absolutely no authority to tell Alaska when and how to certify. The state officials are following Alaska state law, as the Constitution requires." He said he expected the courts to reject the administration's lawsuit.

For months, Republicans have tried to get the second Mr. Sullivan off the ballot, arguing he is a Democratic plant meant to siphon

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NORTH CAROLINA Can Roy Cooper be the first Democrat to win a Senate race since 2008? PAGE A13

MICHIGAN The Senate race between Mike Rogers and Abdul El-Sayed, grows vicious. PAGE A14

NEWS ANALYSIS

Latin America Grows to Like Crackdowns

By JACK NICAS

SÃO PAULO, Brazil — When Flávio Bolsonaro was considering a run for president of Brazil, he flew to one of Latin America's tiniest nations, looking for ideas. President Nayib Bukele of El Salvador had turned what was once the world's deadliest country into one of its safest, largely by rounding up tens of thousands of young men and sentencing them to prison in mass trials.

Mr. Bolsonaro, the son of Brazil's right-wing former president Jair Bolsonaro, was inspired. He announced his campaign a few weeks later, in December, and adopted a platform that called for five new maximum-security prisons, eight-year prison sentences for cellphone thieves and chemical castration for rapists and pedophiles. At a recent rally, he told voters: "I'm starting to think El Salvador isn't enough."

He then won the first round of Brazil's election, and in Sunday's runoff, he is the favorite to win the presidency. That would make Mr. Bolsonaro the eighth consecutive right-wing president elected in Latin America over the past 18 months, all of whom have praised or adopted Mr. Bukele's hard-line tactics.

Many of these new leaders are

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Bass Is Fighting to Regain L.A.'s Faith 2 Years After Fires Erupted in Her Absence

By SHAWN HUBLER

LOS ANGELES — The job was not an obvious next step for a veteran member of Congress. Had city leaders not asked, she might never have considered it. Yet on that October day in 2021, with the pandemic still threatening, it seemed that Karen Bass, the daughter of a postman, had spent her whole life building to that moment as she kicked off her campaign for mayor of Los Angeles.

Hundreds of people crowded the auditorium of a downtown trade school. Some had supported her since 2010, when she won her first House race. Some dated to her rise to Assembly speaker in 2008. Others knew her through the nonprofit she built in the 1990s as a physician assistant organizing against the crack cocaine epidemic.

"Los Angeles, you have called me home, and I'm ready to serve," Ms. Bass said.

Mayor Is Facing Tough Re-election Battle

Five years later, Ms. Bass — who, at 73, has never lost an election — is in the fight of her political life for a second term as mayor. One of the most popular progressives in California when she took office, she has struggled to recapture the city's faith since historic wildfires erupted while she was out of the country in January 2025.

A standoff last summer with the Border Patrol and Immigration and Customs Enforcement over the Trump administration's deportations somewhat reassured this liberal city. So did a reduction in unsheltered homelessness and crime rates.

But then a fire at a cold storage warehouse burned for more than a week in June, blanketing the storied Latino neighborhood of Boyle Heights with a rotten-meat stench that wafted over the freeways. An epidemic of sinkholes highlighted the city's aging infrastructure. The Trump administration also has repeatedly lashed out at the city — all with the 2028 Olympics looming.

An annual survey conducted early this year by the Luskin School of Public Affairs at the University of California, Los Angeles, found that residents across the

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Europe's Heat Kills Thousands
Soaring temperatures this summer contributed to an estimated 50,000 deaths in cities. PAGE A9

Dozing, and Creating Joy
"Puppy Live," a round-the-clock livestream of a litter, has become a national phenomenon in Finland. PAGE A9



NATIONAL A10-17, 20

Legal Immigration Fell Sharply
Trump administration policies have made it all but impossible to immigrate from 91 countries and have reduced visas in 61 more. PAGE A10

Justices Allow Student ID Ban
New Hampshire can direct officials to disregard the identification in verifying voters' identities. PAGE A12

OBITUARIES B11

He Packed a Potent Punch
Wilfredo Gomez, a champ in three weight classes, defended his titles with a record 17 straight knockouts. He was 69.

SPORTS B7-10, 12

No Rings for Knicks Coaches
They did not get championship jewelry on opening night, reportedly because they fell for a phishing email. PAGE B8



A Long-Awaited Moment
Bud Selig, 92, who founded the team that became the Brewers, is savoring a World Series return. PAGE B7

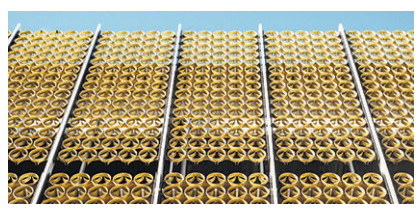
BUSINESS B1-6

Which College Majors Pay Off?
A college-by-college guide offers a way to determine and compare graduates' potential income as families see list prices for popular private institutions go over $100,000 a year. PAGE B5

Acting Over Fears of A.I.
A bill to bolster the unemployment insurance program reflects the concern — and the risks — in Washington around the potential of mass layoffs caused by the technology. PAGE B1

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Michelle Goldberg PAGE A18



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Beyond the Twin Towers
A trip to visit other buildings by the architect Minoru Yamasaki turned up aesthetic echoes from Seattle to Detroit to Saudi Arabia. PAGE C1

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